

CineVerse AI

Product Requirements Document

V1.0 · July 2025 · DRAFT FOR REVIEW

Author	Status
Product Team	Draft — For Review
Target Launch	Live URL
Q4 2025	cine-verseai.lovable.app

1. Product Overview

One-liner: CineVerse AI eliminates decision fatigue by recommending your next movie or book in seconds — personalised to your taste, mood, and what you have already loved.

Live product: cine-verseai.lovable.app

Platform: Responsive web app (Desktop + Mobile Web). Built on Loveable, Supabase, React, TMDB API.

Problem

In a world of infinite content, choosing what to start next is the hardest part. After finishing something great, users spend 15–25 minutes scrolling Netflix, Goodreads, or Letterboxd — wading through algorithmic noise calibrated for platform retention, not user satisfaction — before giving up and rewatching something familiar.

The pain is acutest immediately after finishing something great: users know what they liked but have no reliable, cross-category way to find what is next.

Solution

A mood-and-preference-aware recommendation engine that learns from what users loved and disliked, and surfaces the right pick at the right moment. CineVerse AI is not a generic trending list — it is a curated shortlist that fits the user right now, across both movies and books in a single taste profile.

2. Goals

User Goals

- Find a next pick in under 60 seconds of opening the app
- Feel the recommendation is personalised — not generic — on first use
- Return to the app every time they finish a movie or book
- Maintain a backlog (TBW / TBR) they actually consult, not abandon

Business Goals

- 10,000 monthly active users within 90 days of launch
- 40% D30 retention
- Recommendation-to-action rate of 35% or above (Add to List or Start Here taps per hero card shown)
- Establish CineVerse AI as the go-to cross-category recommendation tool, enabling a Pro tier in V2

Non-Goals (V1)

- Music and podcast recommendations — separate initiative
- Social features — no following, shared lists, or public profiles
- Streaming or purchase deep links — requires commercial partnerships
- Native iOS / Android apps — responsive web validates first

- AI-generated content summaries — copyright and accuracy risk
- Offline mode — all features require connectivity in V1

3. Target Users

Persona A — The Paralysed Finisher

	28–42
	Reads 1–2 books/month, watches 2–4 movies/week. Finishes one thing, spends 30 min deciding the next. Often ends up rewatching.
	Wants to feel good about the choice. Decision regret is real — wasted 2 hours on a film they did not enjoy.
	"Based on your viewing history" surfaces things already seen or clearly irrelevant. No product asks how they feel right now.

Persona B — The List Hoarder

	24–38
	200+ titles on Goodreads "Want to Read", a Notes app full of movie recs never consulted. Asks friends for recommendations constantly.
	Wants a curated, manageable list — not a graveyard of good intentions.
	Existing list apps (Letterboxd, Goodreads) store but do not help decide. The list itself becomes another source of decision fatigue.

4. User Stories

Onboarding

- As a **new user**, I want *set up my taste profile in under 3 minutes* so that the app can give me a relevant first recommendation immediately.
- As a **new user**, I want *select my favourite genres and moods visually* so that the setup feels like part of the product, not a form.
- As a **new user**, I want *tag titles I loved and disliked* so that the recommendation engine has enough signal to avoid things I would hate.

Recommendations

- As a **returning user**, I want *see a single hero recommendation when I open the app* so that I do not have to think — there is already a best pick waiting.
- As a **returning user**, I want *see why a title was recommended for me specifically* so that I can trust the recommendation rather than feeling it is random.
- As a **returning user**, I want *set my mood before getting recommendations* so that I get suggestions that match how I feel right now, not just my long-term preferences.

List Management

- As a **user with saved titles**, I want *add a recommended title to my TBW or TBR list in one tap* so that I capture it without losing momentum.
- As a **user with saved titles**, I want *mark a title as watched/read and rate it* so that the app learns from my reaction and improves future recommendations.
- As a **user with a large backlog**, I want *organise my list into sublists by mood, genre, or length* so that choosing from a smaller relevant slice is easier than scanning 80 titles.

Discovery

- As a **curious user**, I want *browse and filter recommendations by genre, mood, and length* so that I can explore when I am not sure what I want.
- As a **user in Discover**, I want *quickly add or skip a title with two taps* so that I can triage recommendations without opening each detail page.

5. Screen Requirements & Wireframes

All wireframes below are from the Cinematic Noir Stitch design export. The Figma Make prototype is available at: figma.com/make/kmLntfFWmS4oJDtOmrCmmo

Screen 1: Home / Dashboard

The first screen a returning user sees. A large hero recommendation card anchors the experience with a personalised pick, match score, and two primary CTAs. Below it, horizontal shelves for Movies and Books provide additional options. The sidebar is always present on desktop.

Figure 1: Home / Dashboard — Stitch wireframe (Cinematic Noir theme)

Requirements

Hero recommendation card

- Single large card showing top recommendation: cover art (2:3), title, genre pill, mood badge, match score (0–100%), one-line why_blurb, and two CTAs: Add to List and Start Here.

Category shelf rows

- Two horizontal scroll rows (Movies, Books) with 5+ cards each. Each card: thumbnail, title, genre pill, quick-add icon.

Mood re-signal button

- A "Change mood" chip above the hero card allows the user to update their current mood without going to settings.

Acceptance Criteria

- ✓ Hero card is the first element in viewport on desktop and mobile web
- ✓ "X% Match" badge derives from recommendation.match_score
- ✓ "Add to List" opens a bottom sheet to select TBW or TBR + optional sublist
- ✓ "Start Here" sets status to watching/reading and removes from recommendations feed
- ✓ Hero card refreshes when dismissed or marked watched/read
- ✓ Each shelf shows minimum 5 cards and scrolls horizontally

Screen 2: Taste Setup / Onboarding

A 3-step full-screen onboarding flow. Step 1: genre multi-select tile grid. Step 2: mood toggle cards. Step 3: favourites and dislikes signal input with TMDB autocomplete. Progress is saved after each step so the user can resume if interrupted.

Figure 2: Taste Setup / Onboarding — Stitch wireframe (Cinematic Noir theme)

Requirements

Genre selection — step 1

- Visual grid of genre tiles with icon + label. Multi-select. Minimum 1 required to proceed.

Mood selection — step 2

- 4–6 large mood cards (Light & Fun, Deep & Emotional, Mind-bending, Just Chill, Noir, Cerebral). Radio behaviour — one selected at a time. Stored as current_mood per session.

Favourites signal input — step 3

- Search-and-tag field querying TMDB API (debounced 300ms). User tags 3+ as Loved and optionally 1+ as Did Not Like.

Acceptance Criteria

- ✓ Genre tiles toggle on tap with gold border and filled icon
- ✓ At least 1 genre required to advance to step 2
- ✓ Mood is a single-select — selecting a new one deselects the previous
- ✓ TMDB search shows results with cover art and year within 300ms of typing
- ✓ Minimum 3 "Loved" signals required to complete onboarding
- ✓ Progress persists — refreshing mid-onboarding resumes at current step

Screen 3: Recommendation Detail

A two-column detail page for a single title. Left: large cover art with overlaid genre tag and mood badge. Right: metadata, personalised why_blurb, and three stacked action buttons. A "More like this" scroll row anchors the bottom.

Figure 3: Recommendation Detail — Stitch wireframe (Cinematic Noir theme)

Requirements

Detail layout — two column

- Left: cover art (full height), genre tag + mood badge overlaid at bottom-left. Right: title, director/author, year, runtime/pages, why_blurb (from recommendation.why_blurb), 3 stacked CTAs.

Three action buttons

- Add to TBW/TBR — opens list picker bottom sheet.
- Already Watched/Read — prompts star rating (1–5), saves to list_item with status = watched/read.
- Not Interested — sets recommendation.dismissed_at, permanently removes from all surfaces.

"More like this" row

- 4+ related content_items shown as horizontal scroll at bottom of page.

Acceptance Criteria

- ✓ why_blurb is drawn from recommendation.why_blurb — never a generic fallback string
- ✓ "Already Watched/Read" prompts for rating before saving
- ✓ "Not Interested" removes the item from home, discover, and any future recommendation surfaces immediately
- ✓ "More like this" shows items from the same genre and mood that the user has not yet actioned
- ✓ Page is accessible by direct URL for sharing purposes

Screen 4: My Lists

A list management screen with a tab bar (Movies / Books), a sublist sidebar on the left, and a filterable content grid on the right. Each card shows status badge, star rating, and cover art. Filters: status, sort by date/rating/title.

Figure 4: My Lists — Stitch wireframe (Cinematic Noir theme)

Requirements

Tab bar — Movies / Books

- Switches the entire view between movie lists and book lists. State is independent per tab.

Sublist sidebar

- Shows user-created sublists with item count badges. Creation via "+" button opens a name-entry modal. Duplicate names within same content type are rejected.

Filterable content grid

- Filter bar: status (TBW, Watching, Watched, Liked). Sort: Date Added, Rating, Title. Each card: cover thumbnail, title, status badge, star rating, date added.

Add content directly to list

- "Add Content" button opens TMDB search modal to add a title without going through Discover.

Acceptance Criteria

- ✓ Sublists shown in creation order with live item count badge
- ✓ Filter and sort apply immediately without "Apply" button
- ✓ Tapping a card navigates to Recommendation Detail for that item
- ✓ Sublist name max 50 characters; duplicate within same content type shows inline error
- ✓ Newly created list is selected and focused immediately
- ✓ Empty list state shows a prompt to add content or browse Discover

Screen 5: Discover / Browse

A browsable grid of recommendations the user has not yet actioned. A full-width filter bar (Genre, Mood, Length) sits at the top. Cards support quick two-tap Add/Skip actions. Infinite scroll or pagination loads 12+ cards per page.

Figure 5: Discover / Browse — Stitch wireframe (Cinematic Noir theme)

Requirements

Filter bar + masonry grid

- Genre, Mood, Length dropdowns apply immediately. Grid shows only items the user has not actioned (not added, not dismissed).

Add / Skip card actions

- "Skip" sets recommendation.dismissed_at — card disappears without page refresh. "Add" adds to TBW/TBR with confirmation toast.

Empty state

- When all recommendations are actioned, show a prompt to update taste profile or wait for new recommendations.

Acceptance Criteria

- ✓ Filters apply immediately — no Apply button
- ✓ "Skip" removes card from grid client-side; sets dismissed_at server-side
- ✓ "Add" shows confirmation toast and updates list count in My Lists nav badge
- ✓ Grid shows minimum 12 cards per load; infinite scroll or Load More pagination
- ✓ Empty state is shown only after all cards have been actioned — not before load

6. Data Model

The data model is the minimal set of entities required to support every screen and interaction above. Seed data (genre, mood, content_item) exists before any user signs up. Everything with a user_id FK is created by user action.

Entity Overview

USER	User-created	Auth, profile, onboarding flag
GENRE	Seed	Lookup table — movie/book genres
MOOD	Seed	Lookup table — mood options
CONTENT_ITEM	Seed	Movies and books (type discriminator), sourced from TMDB
USER_GENRE_PREF	User-created	Genres selected during onboarding step 1
USER_MOOD_PREF	User-created	Moods selected during onboarding step 2
USER_SIGNAL	User-created	loved / disliked / skipped signals — drives engine
RECOMMENDATION	Engine-created	Per-user pick with match_score and why_blurb
USER_LIST	User-created	Named sublists (TBW, Rainy Day Reads, etc.)
LIST_ITEM	User-created	Title in a list: status, rating, timestamp

Entity Field Tables

Field	Type	Req	Notes
id	uuid	Y	Primary key
email	string	Y	
display_name	string	Y	
avatar_url	string	N	
onboarding_done	boolean	Y	Gates home screen access
created_at	timestamp	Y	

Field	Type	Req	Notes
id	uuid	Y	Seed PK
name	string	Y	e.g. Thriller, Romance
icon	string	Y	SVG or emoji for tile grid
category	enum	Y	movie book both

Field	Type	Req	Notes
id	uuid	Y	Seed PK
name	string	Y	e.g. Light & Fun
description	string	N	Shown on mood card
color_hint	string	N	Hex for badge color

Field	Type	Req	Notes
id	uuid	Y	Seed PK
type	enum	Y	movie book
title	string	Y	
cover_url	string	Y	TMDB image URL
genre_id	uuid FK	Y	→ GENRE.id
mood_id	uuid FK	Y	→ MOOD.id
year	integer	Y	
length_mins	integer	N	Movies only; null for books
length_pages	integer	N	Books only; null for movies
director	string	N	Movies only
author	string	N	Books only

Field	Type	Req	Notes
id	uuid	Y	PK
user_id	uuid FK	Y	→ USER.id
content_item_id	uuid FK	Y	→ CONTENT_ITEM.id
signal	enum	Y	loved disliked skipped
created_at	timestamp	Y	

Field	Type	Req	Notes
id	uuid	Y	PK
user_id	uuid FK	Y	→ USER.id
content_item_id	uuid FK	Y	→ CONTENT_ITEM.id
match_score	integer	Y	0–100; shown on hero card
why_blurb	text	Y	Personalised "Why you will like this"
is_hero	boolean	Y	True for the home hero card pick
dismissed_at	timestamp	N	Set on Not Interested or Skip
created_at	timestamp	Y	

Field	Type	Req	Notes
id	uuid	Y	PK
user_id	uuid FK	Y	→ USER.id
name	string	Y	e.g. Rainy Day Reads
content_type	enum	Y	movie book
created_at	timestamp	Y	

Field	Type	Req	Notes
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id	uuid	Y	PK
list_id	uuid FK	Y	→ USER_LIST.id
content_item_id	uuid FK	Y	→ CONTENT_ITEM.id
status	enum	Y	tbw tbr watching reading watched read liked
rating	decimal(2,1)	N	0.0–5.0; null until rated
added_at	timestamp	Y	

7. Success Metrics

Leading Indicators — measure at Day 7 and Day 30

Onboarding completion rate	—	70%	Users completing Step 3 / total sign-ups
Time to first recommendation	—	< 90 sec	Onboarding end → hero card render
Recommendation-to-action rate	—	35%	(Add + Start Here taps) / hero cards shown
List creation rate	—	50% of users	% users creating 1+ sublist in first session
Discover filter usage	—	40% of sessions	% sessions with 1+ filter applied

Lagging Indicators — measure at Day 30 and Day 90

D30 retention	—	40%	Users returning on or after day 30
Weekly active users	—	5,000 by day 60	Unique users with 1+ session in rolling 7 days
"Not Interested" rate	—	20% or below	Dismissed recs / total recs served
User-rated items per user	—	3+ ratings	Avg LIST_ITEMS with rating not null per active user

8. Open Questions

Blocking — must resolve before development starts

- What is the V1 recommendation engine architecture? Rule-based genre/mood matching, collaborative filtering, or hybrid? This determines the data required at sign-up. [Engineering]
- How do we handle cold start for a new user with no interaction history — editorial picks or additional onboarding prompts? [Product + Engineering]
- TMDB API rate limit at expected traffic — do we need caching or a dedicated tier? [Engineering]

Non-blocking — can resolve during development

- Does current_mood persist across sessions or reset to neutral each time? [Product]
- How many "Not Interested" signals on a genre before we suppress it from recommendations? [Data]
- Should sublists support both movies and books, or stay strictly per content type? [Product]
- Do we support Google / Apple OAuth at launch or email-only? [Engineering + Design]
- Is content moderation needed for sublist names? What is the enforcement mechanism? [Legal]

9. Timeline

Discovery	Week 1–2	Resolve blocking questions, confirm TMDB plan, finalise data model, complete design handoff for all 5 screens
Alpha	Week 3–6	Onboarding (steps 1–3), home hero card, TMDB integration, basic list management. Internal team only.
Beta	Week 7–10	My Lists with sublists and filters, Discover screen, Recommendation Detail, match score engine. Closed beta: 200 users.
V1 Launch	Week 11–12	All P0 requirements complete. P1 features if time permits. Public launch.
V1.1	Week 13–16	Instrument Day 7 / Day 30 metrics. Top feedback addressed. Begin V2 scoping (music, social, native apps).

10. Appendix

A. Design References

- Figma Make prototype: figma.com/make/kmLntfFWmS4oJDtOmrCmmo/CineVerse-AI-app-design
- Stitch wireframe export: 5 screens in Cinematic Noir dark-mode theme (embedded in Section 5)
- Live app: cine-verseai.lovable.app

B. Tech Stack

Frontend	React, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui
Backend / Auth	Supabase (PostgreSQL + Auth)
Content Data	TMDB API (movies and books metadata + cover art)
Dev Platform	Loveable (AI-assisted development)
Design	Google Stitch (Cinematic Noir theme), Figma Make

C. Revision History

1.0	July 2025	Product Team	Initial draft with wireframes and data model